

The Dreaded Missing File Syndrome

Q When I boot into Windows XP Professional, I get an error: "C:\windows\system32\config\system file not found." Windows then stops loading. How can I repair my OS? Is there any way I could allow a Guest to write CDs from their accounts?

James

QUESTION
OF THE
MONTH

A The file 'system' that resides in the 'config' directory of Windows XP's 'System32' directory is part of the Registry. If this file is corrupt, Windows will naturally have problems booting. But you can attempt to repair this error:

1 Insert the Windows XP installation CD and boot through it.

2 When prompted with the "R=Repair" option, press [R].

3 Press the number that corresponds to the correct location for the installation of Windows you want to repair. Typically this will be number 1 if Windows is installed on the C drive.

4 Enter the Administrator password when prompted.

5 Type in the following commands at the command prompt:

```
cd \windows\system32\config
```

```
ren system system.bad
```

```
copy \windows\repair\system
```

6 Eject the CD-ROM and type in "exit".

7 Restart your computer. You should be able to boot into Windows XP properly.

Now for your second query: a user logging on using a Guest account can only view files but cannot modify files in Windows XP. They also will not be able to write CDs.

The MSI MegaView 588, which we reviewed in *New and Notable* in our December 2005 issue, is one such device available in the market.

Accelerating Access

Q My PC configuration is an Intel P IV 530 with HT, Intel original i915GAV motherboard, 512 MB DDR 400 MHz RAM, and a Seagate Barracuda 80 GB hard drive (ST380013AS). The drive supports UDMA-6, but is currently using UDMA-5. Is there a way to make it use its rated data transfer mode?

Mustak Patel

A Installing the Intel Application Accelerator should do it. Since you have an Intel original motherboard, you'll find this application on the driver CD that accompanied the motherboard. You can also download the latest version of Intel Application Accelerator from Intel's Web site, but you must take care to download the version that's meant for your motherboard's chipset and your Windows version.

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Turn to Page 135

Of Codecs And Autorun

Q I have a Celeron 1.2 GHz and a BenQ DVD-ROM running Windows XP. The *Digit* December 2005 movie DVD is getting detected as a data DVD by the DVD-ROM, and I'm not able to view the movie. I want to know whether an upgrade is required for the DVD-ROM, or whether any drivers can help.

Rajdeep Kohli

A There does not seem to be any problem with your DVD-ROM drive. It looks like the Autorun functionality of your drive has been disabled. Some software such as CD-Writing software and virtual machines require the Autorun feature on optical drives to be disabled in order to function properly, and these disable Autorun when they are installed.

Regardless of whether Autorun is turned on or off, you will still be able to view DVD movies, provided you have the necessary DVD player and MPEG-2 codecs installed. Most DVD players such as InterVideo WinDVD

(www.intervideo.com) and Cyberlink PowerDVD (www.cyberlink.com) come with their own codecs, and installing one of these will allow you to view DVD movies using either the player or Windows Media Player.

Squeezing It To The Max

Q Is there any software that can compress 5 to 6 GB of data to 500 to 600 MB?

Kishore Jethanandani

A Compressing 5 to 6 GB of data to 500 or 600 MB means a compression ratio of 1:10, which is extremely high. While not impossible, it's very hard to achieve. It depends on the type of files you're planning to compress—certain file types such as BMP and DOC compress better. There are a host of file compression utilities that can help you compress files to a varying degree of compression. WinZip (www.winzip.com), WinRAR (www.rarsoft.com), WinAce (www.winace.com),

PowerArchiver (www.powerarchiver.com), and 7-Zip (www.7-zip.org) are some of these.

TV-Tuner On Win98?

Q I have a Pentium III 500MHz, a SiS P-II motherboard, 96 MB of RAM, and Windows 98. This system runs fine—I generally use it for music and video. I want to add a TV-Tuner card. But my vendor has expressed doubts as to whether my P-II motherboard will support a TV-Tuner card. He also said that the TV-Tuner cards available in the market do not have driver support for Windows 98. I want to know whether this is true or not.

Srikanth Vavilala

A Any system with at least a Pentium 233 MHz and 32 MB of RAM will support a TV-Tuner card for viewing purposes. The dealer must have meant that capturing live TV might not be possible on your system, and that is true. Most, if not all, TV-Tuners—such as the Compro Videomate PVR and PVR/FM cards—still support Windows 98. You'll be able to find the drivers on the Internet. ■



Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!